fieldwork

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Objection handling

Fieldwork · Practise AI on real work.

Objection handling

Version 0.1, 14 October 2026. Honest responses for a new company with no case studies. Pattern for every objection: **acknowledge, ask, answer honestly, offer a small next step.** Never invent a client, a result or a statistic. If you do not know, say so and offer to find out. Nothing here is legal advice.

How to use this

- Read the objection aloud to yourself in the buyer's words, not yours.
- Ask one clarifying question before answering. Often the real objection is different.
- Answer in under 45 seconds. Offer a small, low-risk next step.
- Log every objection verbatim in the CRM (see CRM-FIELDS-AND-PIPELINE.md). The patterns drive product and messaging.

Objections

Value and need

1. "We already use ChatGPT." Ask: "Good. Who uses it, for what, and is there a shared way of doing it?" Answer: "That is the common starting point, and I am not suggesting you switch tools. Training is about how people use whichever tool you have: a shared brief, a check against source and a clear rule on what never goes in. If everyone is already doing that consistently, you may not need us. Most teams I expect to meet have individual habits, not shared practice. The free assessment will tell you quickly." Next step: offer the assessment.

2. "Our staff are already good with AI." Ask: "How do you know? Could you show me two negotiators' listings for similar properties?" Answer: "Individual skill is common. Consistent, checked output across a team is the harder part. If your team is already at that level, a pilot is not for you yet." Next step: offer to review a sample of their own practice, anonymised.

3. "We don't have time." Ask: "What takes the time at the moment?" Answer: "I would not ask for a training day. The pilot is built from short sessions, about [30 to 45] minutes a week for participants over two weeks, on work they already do. If your team cannot spare even that, wait. A pilot will not work if you cannot give it room." Next step: propose a smaller group of three to five.

4. "It's too expensive." Ask: "Compared with what? Is it the total, or the uncertainty?" Answer: "I understand. The pilot is a fixed fee, scoped to what you need, and you can stop at the end of any week and pay only for work done. I cannot promise savings, so I will not justify the price with a number I cannot support. What I can do is help you measure time and quality against your own baseline, so you decide with facts. If the full pilot is too much, a single practice session on one workflow costs less." Next step: smaller scope, not a bigger discount.

5. "AI is a fad / we're waiting to see." Answer: "That is reasonable. Your staff may already be using it, which is the part worth checking. The free assessment asks that directly. If nobody is using it and you do not want them to, a one-page rule might be all you need." Next step: free exercise and rule template.

6. "We tried it and it gave rubbish." Ask: "What went wrong? Wrong facts, bad tone, something else?" Answer: "That is a very normal experience, and it is why our method has a check step and a clear brief. Bad output often comes from vague instructions or from asking the tool to do something it should not. We will not claim it never fails." Next step: bring an example of the rubbish and fix it together in a 20-minute call.

7. "What is the ROI?" Answer: "I do not have an ROI figure and I would distrust anyone who gave you one before measuring your own workflows. What I propose is a baseline in week 0 or 1 and a comparison in week 4. Then you decide."

Credibility

8. "You have no case studies." Answer: "That is right. Fieldwork is new, and the website says so. I would rather show you a worked, fictional scenario than invent a testimonial. That is also why the pilot is small, priced to match its risk, with a stop clause, and why founding partners get a discount in return for honest feedback." Next step: demo, then a small pilot.

9. "Who else have you worked with?" Answer: "No agencies yet. I can tell you what I have done: built the method, published a free exercise and an assessment, and designed the pilot. If you want a supplier with a long client list, I am not that yet."

10. "Why should we trust a new company?" Answer: "You should limit the risk instead. Fixed fee, short scope, written deliverables, stop at the end of any week, no personal data, no lock-in, and you keep everything we create. I will also tell you where I am unsure."

11. "Who are you? Do you have a team?" *(Do not invent bios.)* Answer: "I am [YOUR NAME]. [One honest sentence about relevant background: PLACEHOLDER, truthful only.] I deliver the work myself. If a pilot needs more capacity I will say so and tell you who would help before they do."

12. "Are you a market research company? There are other Fieldworks." Answer: "Different business. 'Fieldwork' is also used in market research, and we are aware of the overlap. We teach practical AI use. [Founder: check trademark position, see docs/operations/DOMAIN-AND-TRADEMARK.md.]"

13. "Can we speak to a reference?" Answer: "Not yet. After the first pilots, with permission, you could."

14. "How do you know this works?" Answer: "I do not know it will for you. That is why the pilot measures. The method itself (brief, run, check, keep) is simple, and you can see it on the free exercise before paying anything."

Data, risk and regulation

15. "What about data protection?" Answer: "It is the right question. Our default is that no client personal data is used. Practice runs on anonymised or fictional examples, and the AI-use rule you write with us says what never goes into a tool. UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018 apply in the UK, and the Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023 in Nigeria. [Verify with your own adviser; I am not giving legal advice.] If a data processing arrangement is needed, we agree it in writing before any work."

16. "What happens to our documents?" Answer: "Only redacted copies, only what you choose to share, kept in [LOCATION], seen only by [WHO], deleted within [N] days of the end. Written into the Statement of Work." [Confirm each item is true before saying it.]

17. "Will AI use make us non-compliant with the regulator / The Property Ombudsman / ESVARBON?" Answer: "I cannot tell you what applies to you, and nobody providing training can. In the UK the relevant material includes consumer protection rules on listings, redress scheme codes and client money protection [verify: details and current guidance with your professional body or solicitor]. In Nigeria it depends on your registration and professional bodies [verify]. What we do is give your staff a method that includes checking every claim against source and a list of things never to use AI for, such as legal statements and valuations."

18. "What if the tool invents a fact in a listing?" Answer: "It can, and it will sometimes. That is why every workflow has a check against source and a named person who approves. Misleading descriptions are a risk whether written by a person or a tool. The training makes the check habitual."

19. "Can we upload our client database so it learns our business?" Answer: "I would advise against that, and it is not part of what we do. Uploading personal data into tools without clear approval is the risk we help you avoid."

20. "Staff will be replaced / staff are afraid of being replaced." Answer: "I do not advise on headcount and I do not promise cuts. The training is built around people deciding, checking and sending. In my experience of the problem so far, the more useful aim is consistent quality and less repeated admin, not fewer people. [Note: not experience from client work. Say 'what I expect' not 'what I have seen'.] Be open with your staff on why you are doing the pilot, and I can help with that briefing."

21. "Can AI price our properties / assess tenants / approve offers?" Answer: "No. I will not suggest that, and I will not teach it. Valuations, legal statements and approving offers or tenancies stay with qualified people. AI drafts. People decide."

Delivery and fit

22. "Our team is not technical." Answer: "Good. Neither is the training. It uses tasks they already do, plain language and checklists."

23. "We're in Nigeria. Will it work on our connection and budgets?" Answer: "We design practice for free tool tiers and mobile connections, and prices are set in naira, not converted from pounds. Sessions can be text-first and short. [Verify tool availability and terms in Nigeria for the specific tools used before the pilot.]"

24. "Can you build us a chatbot / custom assistant / onboarding platform?" Answer: "Not today. The onboarding and knowledge platform is a plan, not built and not for sale. What we can do now is turn your procedures into checklists and quick guides, owned by you. If the platform interests you I can add you to the list."

25. "We want a big rollout across all branches immediately." Answer: "I would advise starting with six to ten people on one workflow. A big rollout is easy to start and hard to change habits with. If the pilot works, we widen."

26. "Can you just record a video for everyone?" Answer: "Videos explain; practice changes habits. The reusable material is the core, but I would not sell you a video as a substitute for practising on your own work."

27. "We need it guaranteed." Answer: "I cannot guarantee productivity, compliance or savings, and I would not trust a provider who did. I can guarantee a fixed scope, a fixed fee and honest reporting."

28. "Can you start next week?" Answer: "Possibly. The first week is the conversation and baseline, so the quickest start is a call this week. [Confirm real capacity before saying yes.]"

29. "We'll think about it." Ask: "Of course. What would you need to think through, and shall I check in on [date]?" Next step: agree a specific date and one unresolved question. Log it.

30. "Send me some information." Answer: "Gladly. To send the right thing, what is the one question you most need answered?" Then send the one-pager plus a link to the free exercise, and book a follow-up.

31. "We use another training company / the portal provides this." Answer: "Then compare. Ask them what the staff do on their own work and how they check output. If that is covered, you may not need us."

When to walk away

Wants AI to value, advise legally or approve; wants guarantees; wants free work with no commitment; wants to paste client data; wants the unbuilt platform. Say so kindly and record the reason.